

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS for **FIRE APPARATUS**

Issued by
The State of Mississippi
Department of Finance and Administration
Office of Purchasing, Travel and Fleet Management



In collaboration with



SOLICITATION NUMBER #3120003350

RFP WEBSITE: <https://www.dfa.ms.gov/current-bids-and-proposals>



RFP OVERVIEW

I. INTRODUCTION

This Request for Proposals (RFP) is being issued by the State of Mississippi ("Lead State") in collaboration with the NASPO ValuePoint cooperative purchasing program. The purpose of this RFP is to establish one or more Master Agreements for Fire Trucks and Fire Apparatus.

There are seven (7) categories for award. An Offeror may submit a response for any number of the categories but must be able to provide at least one category to be considered for award. The categories are shown below:

1. Aerial
2. Electric Aerial
3. Pumper
4. Tanker
5. Rescue
6. Wildland
7. Aircraft Rescue and Firefighting (ARFF)

Awards will only be considered at the manufacturer level. Individual dealers, resellers, and/or authorized distributors of a manufacturer will only be considered if they have an approval letter from the manufacturer to submit a proposal to the solicitation on behalf of the manufacturer.

While it is anticipated that through a combination of Offerors national coverage and deliverability is obtained, an Offeror is NOT required to cover every State and/or territory. An Offeror, at a minimum, must be able to cover and provide service to at least one State.

About NASPO ValuePoint

NASPO ValuePoint is a division of the National Association of State Procurement Officials (NASPO), a non-profit association dedicated to advancing public procurement through leadership, excellence, and integrity. In accordance with NASPO ValuePoint's Lead State Model™, the Lead State is issuing this RFP, evaluating responses, and establishing Master Agreements with the support and assistance of a Multistate Sourcing Team™ composed of individuals from other member states, representing a broad range of perspectives that ensure the RFP incorporates best practices recognized by public entities across the country.

Participation in NASPO ValuePoint Master Agreements is convenient and cost-effective for eligible entities—including state departments, institutions, agencies, and political subdivisions, federally recognized tribes, and other eligible public and nonprofit entities in the 50 states, the District of Columbia, and U.S. territories—and suppliers, with no membership or registration required. In **2024**, contractors reported a combined **\$21.07 billion** in sales through NASPO ValuePoint Master Agreements awarded through cooperative solicitations like this RFP, including a combined **\$54.86 million** in sales through the current Fire Apparatus portfolio.

More information about NASPO, NASPO ValuePoint, and the NASPO ValuePoint Lead State Model can be found at www.naspo.org and www.naspovaluepoint.org and in Attachment E, Participation Information.

II. GENERAL INFORMATION AND INSTRUCTIONS

A. RFP Contact. The following individual is the sole contact for this RFP:

**Request for Proposals for
FIRE APPARATUS**

Issued by the **State of Mississippi**
Solicitation Number # 3120003350



Ramona Jones
Director of Travel and Fleet Support Contracts
State of Mississippi
Ramona.Jones@dfa.ms.gov
(601) 359-9335

B. RFP Website. The following website is the sole official source for RFP information and updates:

- <https://www.dfa.ms.gov/current-bids-and-proposals>

Registration - State of Mississippi E- Procurement System

Vendors must register at <https://www.dfa.ms.gov/vendors>. Once on the Vendor Registration/Self Service page, please select the Vendor Registration/Self Service link in the first box. Additionally, suppliers will need to select or add the product category code **07000 (Fire Trucks)** during registration to receive notification of the solicitation. Vendors **MUST** enter a valid email address in order to receive the solicitation notification. This notification is sent via the MAGIC portal once the solicitation is published.

If you currently have a Contract for the commodity listed above or with the State of Mississippi and you are unsure of your vendor number, please contact Ramona Jones at Ramona.Jones@dfa.ms.gov or 601-359-9335.

State contract vendors that **do not** have a MAGIC User ID and password, should email mash@dfa.ms.gov with the subject line "Vendor ID Request and include:

- MAGIC Vendor Number (MAGIC Vendor Number is different than the MAGIC User ID)
- Vendor Name
- Contact Name
- Contact Email Address
- Contact Phone Number

Newly registered suppliers who have received a User ID and Password must upload a W-9 to their MAGIC account or submit it to ofmmagic@dfa.ms.gov.

Suppliers currently registered within the MAGIC system are encouraged to access the system immediately after receiving notice of this solicitation. Suppliers are required to update their passwords every 30 days, and password updates can take as much as 36 hours to be approved for access to the system.

The State of Mississippi will not be responsible for suppliers who wait until the last minute to reset their password and fail to submit a timely proposal.

Manufacturers are responsible for keeping all profile and dealer information current. Unregistered dealers will not be listed in the eProcurement ordering system or receive any orders from state agencies.

C. RFP Documents. This RFP consists of this RFP Overview, the following attachments, and any information or materials posted by the Lead State to the RFP Website, as amended:

1. Attachment A, RFP Terms and Conditions
2. Attachment B, Scope of Work
3. Attachment C, RFP Evaluation Plan
4. Attachment D, Sample Master Agreement



5. Attachment E, Participation Information
6. Attachment F, Protest Information
7. Attachment G, Offeror Information, Acknowledgements, and Certifications
8. Attachment H, Offeror Response Worksheet
9. Attachment I, Cost Proposal
10. Attachment J, Proposed Modifications to Sample Master Agreement
11. Attachment K, Claim of Business Confidentiality
12. Exhibit 1 – Florida ITP Fire
13. Exhibit 2 – Hawaii ITP Fire
14. Exhibit 3 – Illinois ITP Fire
15. Exhibit 4 – Indiana ITP Fire
16. Exhibit 5 – Maine ITP Fire
17. Exhibit 6 – Montana ITP Fire
18. Exhibit 7 – New Mexico ITP Fire
19. Exhibit 8 – South Dakota ITP Fire
20. Exhibit 9 – Texas ITP Fire
21. Exhibit 10 – Utah ITP Fire
22. Exhibit 11 – Washington ITP Fire

D. Important Dates.

1. **RFP Open Date:** May 1, 2026
2. **RFP Q&A Deadline:** May 18, 2026, 4:00 PM Central Time
3. **RFP Close Date:** June 10, 2026, 4:00 PM Central Time.

Dates and deadlines are subject to change. Offerors should continue checking the RFP Website for the most up-to-date information.

E. How to Ask Questions.

1. **Read and review this RFP, including all attachments, exhibits, and amendments.**
2. For questions about the content of this RFP, send your questions via email to the RFP Contact, Ramona Jones, at Ramona.Jones@dfa.ms.gov. Questions must reference the specific section of the RFP to which the question relates.
3. All questions related to the solicitation must be submitted by the Q & A Deadline listed above.
4. All questions submitted by the deadline will be answered by the RFP Contact via an amendment to the solicitation wherein all questions will be compiled in one document. The amendment with all questions answered will be posted at least 2 weeks prior to the submission due date.
5. For assistance with technical issues associated with the RFP Website, contact the help desk at mash@dfa.ms.gov or via phone at (601) 359-1343.

F. How to Respond.

1. **Read and review this RFP, including all attachments, exhibits, and amendments.**
2. Prepare a proposal that:
 - a. Follows the requested format;
 - b. Includes the Solicitation Number on all materials making up the proposal;
 - c. Addresses each question and request for a response in this RFP, including all questions in Attachment H, Offeror Response Worksheet;
 - d. Clearly demonstrates your ability to meet the Scope of Work



- e. Includes all required submissions identified in Section IV.A below.
- 3. Submit your proposal by the RFP Close Date. Proposals will only be accepted via the following two methods:
 - a. Submitted electronically in the MAGIC portal or
 - b. Via mail courier service postmarked AND received by the deadline at the address listed below:

**E.T Woolfolk Building
501 N. West Street
7th Floor, Suite A
Jackson, MS 39201
Attention: Ramona Jones**

- 4. Responses sent via email will be deemed non-responsive.

III. SCOPE OF WORK

A detailed description of the Deliverables being sought through this RFP is attached as Attachment B, Scope of Work.

The scope of this RFP and its resulting Master Agreement(s) is intended to benefit all state departments, institutions, agencies, and political subdivisions and other eligible public and nonprofit entities in the 50 states, the District of Columbia, and U.S. territories. Therefore, **Offerors should not interpret the Scope of Work to be associated with or limited to any specific purchase, implementation, project, need, or program** within the Lead State or any other state or eligible entity. Proposals should be generally applicable to all potential Participating Entities and Purchasing Entities, except where specificity is requested.

The initial term of the Master Agreement(s) resulting from this RFP is anticipated to be three (3) years, with the option to exercise one (1) year renewals totaling up to an additional 2 years following the initial term, upon mutual agreement by the Lead State and Contractor. Total Master Agreement term not to exceed five (5) years.

IV. OFFEROR RESPONSE

A. Required Submissions. The following must be submitted with your proposal:

- 1. Any response required to be submitted directly through the RFP Website;
- 2. Attachment G, Offeror Information, Acknowledgements, and Certifications. Completed, signed, and submitted.
- 3. Attachment H, Offeror Response Worksheet. Completed and submitted.
- 4. Attachment I, Cost Proposal, submitted as a separate document and separate file, if submitting electronically
- 5. Attachment J, Proposed Modifications to Sample Master Agreement. Completed and submitted if requested modifications to Attachment D.
- 6. Attachment D, Sample Master Agreement, if proposing modifications must submit a redlined copy.
- 7. Attachment K, Claim of Business Confidentiality. Completed and signed.
- 8. Redacted copy of proposal clearly marked as such, if claiming confidential, proprietary, or protected information

B. Other Documents. The following are informational only and do **not** need to be submitted with your proposal:



1. This RFP Overview
2. Attachment A, RFP Terms and Conditions
3. Attachment B, Scope of Work
4. Attachment C, RFP Evaluation Plan
5. Attachment D, Sample Master Agreement
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V. EVALUATION AND AWARD PROCESS

- A. Proposals will be sealed until the RFP Close Date. After opening, proposals will be evaluated in stages as set forth in this section and further detailed in Attachment C, RFP Evaluation Plan.
1. **Stage 1: Initial Responsiveness Evaluation.** Proposals will be reviewed for completeness and initial responsiveness. Proposals omitting required documents or responses may be rejected in accordance with Attachment A, RFP Terms and Conditions.
 2. **Stage 2: Mandatory Minimum Requirements Evaluation.** Complete and responsive proposals will be reviewed for compliance with mandatory minimum requirements. Proposals failing to meet or exceed all Mandatory Minimum Requirements identified in Attachment C, RFP Evaluation Plan may be rejected in accordance with Attachment A, RFP Terms and Conditions.
 3. **Stage 3: Technical Criteria Evaluation.** Proposals meeting or exceeding the Mandatory Minimum Requirements will be evaluated against the Technical Criteria set forth in Attachment C, RFP Evaluation Plan and described below:

Criteria	Criteria Weight	Technical Points Possible	Offeror's Technical Points Earned
Criteria 1: Experience, Skills, and Qualifications	40	200	
Criteria 2: Ability to Meet the Scope of Work	40	200	
Criteria 3: Customer Service and Distribution Network	30	150	



Criteria 4: Implementation of the NASPO Master Agreement	10	100	
Stage 3 Total:		650	

Per Mississippi (MS) Statute 3.107.10, proposal technical scores will be initially classified with the following two designations:

- a. **Potentially Acceptable:** Any Offeror that receives at least 422.5 points
- b. **Unacceptable:** Any Offeror that receives less than 422.5 points.

Offerors earning a minimum of 422.5 points (65% of available Technical Points) will be deemed Potentially Acceptable (MS Statute 3.107.10) for the technical stage and move on to Stage 4: Cost Evaluation. The proposal of any Offeror not earning the minimum of 422.5 points will be deemed Unacceptable and will not proceed to the Cost Stage.

4. **Stage 4: Cost Evaluation.** Cost Proposals for proposals not rejected following evaluation of Technical Criteria will be evaluated according to Attachment I Cost Proposal. Per MS Statute 3.107.07, the Cost Stage must account for at least 35% of all available points. The Cost Stage in this solicitation consists of 350 points per category. Cost Proposals may also be subject to an independent review for reasonableness and best value by the Lead State. Costs determined not to be reasonable or best-value by the Lead State may result in all or part of Offeror's proposal being rejected, notwithstanding the results of the Cost Proposal evaluation.

- a. BAFO – The Lead State may request offerors to submit their Best and Final Offers (“BAFO”) and submit their lowest price. If the Lead State elects to issue a BAFO, Offerors shall be informed of the BAFO, the deadline for submission, and how to submit. They shall also be notified that if they do not submit a BAFO, the immediate previous offer will be considered their BAFO. The Lead State shall request BAFOs only once unless it makes a written determination it is in best interest to require another submission of BAFOs. The Lead State shall maintain the written determination in the Procurement File.
- b. Discussions may be conducted with Offerors who submit proposals determined to be reasonably susceptible of being selected for award, however, it is not a requirement for such discussions to take place and proposals may also be accepted without such discussions.

- B. After evaluations are completed, the Lead State and Multistate Sourcing Team will determine which proposals are most advantageous to the Lead State and potential Participating Entities and Purchasing Entities. The Lead State and Multistate Sourcing Team will then determine which proposals are most advantageous to the Lead State and potential Participating Entities and Purchasing Entities.

1. In accordance with MS Statute 3.107.12, all Offerors shall be ranked according to their combined technical and cost scores. While ranking will help identify top scoring Offerors, there is no predefined cut off amongst the rankings to determine which are acceptable to Mississippi e.g. “only the top 5 ranked proposals will be deemed acceptable.” The Lead State and Multistate Sourcing Team have determined that, regardless of ranking, the



threshold for being deemed acceptable and eligible for award will be 650 points out of 1000.

2. All Offerors earning a minimum of 65% (650 points) or more from the combined Technical Criteria Evaluation and Cost Evaluation Points (1000) will be deemed Acceptable (MS Statute 3.107.10) and be eligible for a Master Agreement award. The proposal of any Offeror not earning the minimum of 650 points combined with the Technical Criteria Evaluation and Cost Evaluation will be deemed Unacceptable and not eligible for an award.
- C. Prior to the execution of any Master Agreement, the Lead State will present an award recommendation to NASPO ValuePoint for approval of the proposed awards.
 - D. Following approval of NASPO ValuePoint and the Lead State, Master Agreements will be executed with awarded Offerors.
 - E. Award notice will be posted after the effective date of the Master Agreements.